2023-2024 Grant Program Application

Fuels & Forest Health Projects

Forest Restoration and Wildfire Risk Mitigation Grant Program

Established by SB 17-050

Application Instructions

Applicants should use Adobe Acrobat or the free Adobe Reader software to edit this PDF application for the most reliable results. Write in complete sentences and provide as much detail as needed for reviewers to understand all aspects of proposed projects. All blocks are fill-in enabled and limited to a certain number of characters. Characters include letters, numbers, spaces and punctuation.

Note: Additional support materials beyond the allowable support letters, maps and contract bids will not be considered.

A. Applicant Information

To receive Forest Restoration and Wildfire Risk Mitigation (FRWRM) grant funds, the applicant or fiscal agent must be registered with the IRS and have a tax identification number. Fiscal agents often take responsibility for financial or other types of transactions for another entity. If the applicant organization will not be the direct fiscal agent for contracting purposes, list the name of the desired fiscal agent. For the purposes of this grant application and the resulting grant agreement, a fiscal agent is a separate entity that agrees to assure that a project will use awarded grant funds to accomplish the activities described in the grant application and the resulting grant agreement.

Note: The fiscal agent must remain unchanged during the full period of the grant.

Name of Project:	Castle View Forest Restoration Project
Applicant/Fiscal Agent:	Lee Driscoll
Type of Organization:	State Agency
Contact Person/Title:	Lee Driscoll
Mailing Address:	1130 South Franklin Street
City/State/Zip Code:	Denver, CO 80210
County:	Denver
Phone (Work/Cell):	303-641-7525
Email:	lee@wynkoop.com
☐ **Yes** ■ **No**	Is this application associated with a separate Capacity Building application?
☐ **Yes** ■ **No**	If yes to the above, is the proposed Capacity Building Project contingent upon funding of this Fuels & Forest Health Project?

B. Eligibility

This section includes a checklist of **required** elements for each application. If the application does not include all of the items below (any items checked "No"), the application will be considered ineligible. Instructions on using the Colorado Forest Atlas to generate required maps and determine if project is located within the WUI are listed on page 3.

Did you attach **required** 1-page map showing project area **IN** the Colorado Forest Atlas with the 2020 Colorado Forest Action Plan Composite Priority theme **and** Social Vulnerability Index visible?

■ **Yes** ☐ **No**

Is the project located in the wildland-urban interface (WUI) of Colorado?

■ **Yes** ☐ **No**

Have you contacted the Colorado State Forest Service Colorado Wood Utilization and Marketing (CoWood) program **as required**? CoWood: Tim Reader, Program Specialist of Utilization & Marketing, (970) 247-5250 or tim.reader@colostate.edu ☒ **Yes** ☐ **No** **Date of Correspondence:**
Have you contacted forest products or wood utilization businesses or incorporated wood utilization as **required?** All applicants are required to reach out to wood utilization businesses unless the applicant is utilizing all woody materials**.** ☒ **Yes** ☐ **No**
Do you have a **required** plan for utilizing forest products/woody materials generated by the project? If utilization is not a viable option, applicants must describe what will occur to materials generated from the project. ☒ **Yes** ☐ **No**
Have you consulted with county officials on this project and attached a **required** letter of support? Acceptable county officials may be commissioners, sheriff's office representatives, forester/forestry staff, or wildfire coordinators. ☒ **Yes** ☐ **No**
Do you have **required** formal commitment for matching funds? Matching funds confirmation can be communicated through letters of support. ☐ **Yes** ☐ **No**
By checking yes, you indicate that the contents of this application are accurate to the best of your knowledge and you agree to all contracting requirements, including reporting and monitoring requirements, as outlined in the Request for Applications. ☐ **Yes** ☐ **No**

From the Colorado Forest Atlas homepage, launch the Wildfire Risk Reduction Planner application to create a project area, determine if project is within the WUI, and view and print maps of the project area with both the Composite Priority Theme and Social Vulnerability Index layer visible. The Wildfire Risk Reduction Planner application requires users to create an account with the Colorado Forest Atlas, free of charge, before they can access the application. Account requests are usually approved within 1 day of submitting the request.

2020 Forest Action Plan Composite Theme

The Composite Priority Map prioritizes areas that address combined Themes of Forest Conditions, Living with Wildfire and Watershed Protection. The Forest Conditions Theme Priority Map evaluates threats such as insect and disease disturbance, canopy fire and land use conversion. The Living with Wildfire Theme Priority Map evaluates wildfire risk including the wildland urban interface, drinking water assets, forest and riparian assets combined with burn probabilities. The Watershed Protection Theme Priority Map evaluates improving and maintaining quality of water and infrastructure by looking at infrastructure and predicted post-fire erosion rates. More information on the 2020 Colorado Forest Action Plan and Themes can be found on the Colorado Forest Atlas Homepage.

Additional risk maps, such as a Community Wildfire Protection Plan (CWPP) map or other Forest Action Plan Theme maps such as Watershed Protection or Forest Conditions, may be included and should be clearly labeled.

Social Vulnerability Index (SVI)

Projects located partially or fully in areas identified as having Fewer Economic Resources may match 25% in cash and/or in-kind match to 75% grant funds for the total project budget. All other projects must match 50% in cash and/or in-kind match to 50% grant funds for the total project budget. When viewing the SVI, the project areas located within the cross-hatching indicate a project is eligible for a 25% match. Additional information on the SVI and how areas of fewer economic resources are defined can be found on the Wildfire Risk Reduction Planner application in the Colorado Forest Atlas.

Instructions for creating REQUIRED project area map with the Composite Priority and SVI layers visible, and determining if the project is located in the WUI (Click here to view step-by-step images of this process):

1. Launch the Wildfire Risk Reduction Planner application.
2. Navigate to the *Analyze Project Areas* section in the menu on the left and click the **"*Manage Project Areas*"** button. A *Manage Project Areas* menu box will open.
3. Click the **"+"** button in the bottom right corner of the *Manage Project Areas* menu to create a new project area. The project area can be created by using the drawing tool within the application or you have the option of uploading an existing shapefile or kml file containing the project area if you already have one. Shapefiles must be in a compressed zip folder and projected in NAD 1983 UTM Zone 13N coordinate reference system. When uploading a shapefile, you must press the **"*Select*"** button and then click on your shapefile in the map (it should turn green when selected) and click **"*Finish*"**.
4. After you've created the project area, select the project area within the *Manage Project Areas* box to activate this project area.
5. Expand the *Explore Map Themes* in the menu on the left and click the **"*Landscape Characteristics*"** and turn on the **"Wildland Urban Interface"** layer. If your project area falls within or touches the Wildland Urban Interface layer, you can answer "YES" on this application question. You can now turn the layer off.
6. Expand the View *Reference Layers* and turn on required **"Social Vulnerability Index"** layer and any relevant layers, such as *County Boundaries*. If your project area falls within the cross-hatching, that indicates you are eligible for a 25% match.
7. Expand the Explore *Map Themes* icon and click the **"*2020 Forest Action Plan*"** icon and enable the **"Forest Action Plan Composite"** layer. Adjust the *Theme Transparency* in order to see any relevant Reference Layers.
8. Scroll down on the left-hand side of the page to the "*Print Map*" function and click on "**Print Map**." Click the check mark inside a circle on the map to indicate the area surrounded by the dashed rectangle is the area that should be printed, and then click **"Print."**
9. The application may run a few minutes while creating a map. A Composite Priority map with the SVI layer and project area boundaries will be created. This 1-page map is **required** to be attached to your application.

If further assistance is needed, reference the user manual on the Colorado Forest Atlas support page or contact us using the form on the Colorado Forest Atlas Contact page.

C. Project Summary

Provide a brief narrative summarizing the overall project and answer the questions listed below.

All information for the project must fit into the allotted 500-character space. Characters include letters, numbers, spaces and punctuation.

This project will be administered by CSFS foresters and involves 700 acres of forest restoration treatments to reduce hazardous fuels and promote forest health across 5 landowners and 1 school district properties outside of Bailey, CO. These treatments are located in Denver Water and Aurora Water Zones of Concern. This project is in a Rocky Mountain Restoration Initiative focus area and is adjacent to previous and planned Jefferson Conservation District, USFS, and CSFS treatments.

Estimated number of homes directly affected by this project:	40
Total number of acres* to be treated: Acreage can be measured using the measure tool in the CO Forest Atlas	700
Estimated federal acres (if applicable): Project must maintain continuity (within 1-mile) across a landscape including federal lands and the total federal acres must be less than combined total of non-federal acres.	0
Estimated cost/acre:	$3000/ac

Is this project identified through a community-based collaborative process (CWPP, FEMA approved hazard mitigation plan, or similar)? If yes, please list plan name(s).	Yes: In-Progress Jefferson County CWPP
What year was the CWPP/similar plan completed or revised?	2023-2024
Will this project involve a contract with an accredited Colorado Youth or Veterans Corps Association? If yes, please name the group. Letter of support required to receive preference points	Yes?
Will this project or future projects utilizing purchase(s) result in the protection of water supplies?	Yes
In the instance of the project being partially funded, is it still viable with reduced outcomes (i.e., is the project scalable)? Briefly explain.	Yes

***Estimated number of acres** should only include treated acres within project boundaries and should not include areas that are inoperable, inaccessible, or untreated "reserves" within project areas.

D. Project Relation to Forest Action Plan

The goals of the FRWRM Program, to reduce wildfire risk in the WUI and promote forest health and wood utilization, align with the Colorado State Forest Action Plan (FAP) Themes (T) and Goals (G) listed below. Briefly explain the project objectives and clearly describe how they align with each of these FAP Goals, where applicable. Describe the specific approaches that will be taken to meet these Goals and explain how they are scientifically supported. Reference the FAP for details on each Theme, Goal, Strategy and Approach.

FAP Theme 1 (T1): Forest Conditions
G1: Keep forests as forests.
G2: Improve forest productivity.
G3: Promote adaptive management.

FAP Theme 2 (T2): Living With Wildfire
G1: Promote community fire adaptation.
G2: Reduce risk of uncharacteristic wildfire.
G3: Promote the role of fire in ecological processes.

FAP Theme 3 (T3): Watershed Protection (Additional preference given for proposal that include the protection of water supply)
G2: Improve resiliency of critical water infrastructure.

All information for the project must fit into the allotted 1,500-character space. Characters include letters, numbers, spaces and punctuation.

The Castle View project truly embodies the goals of the Forest Action Plan. Through cross-boundary collaboration with multiple partners, we will be treating 700 ac of forest adjacent to the Lost Creek Wilderness. Mixed conifer and ponderosa pine stands will be thinned to promote ponderosa pine and aspen regeneration and reduce canopy cover and ladder fuels. There are many decadent lodgepole pine stands that will be patch-cut or clearcut to regenerate the stands. The result will be a significant reduction in fire behavior and an increase in forest health and resilience. The grasses and other ground flora populations as well as aspen seedlings that grow in response to the more open canopy will enhance wildlife habitat as well.

Elk Creek and North Fork Fire will assist in home ignition zone assessments for the campus at the Windy Peak Outdoor Lab, and CSFS will assist in forest management on the Jeffco School district property.

Aurora Water and Denver Water have each independently identified the Castle View project area as high priority Zone of Concern due to its potential to cause significant impact to Front Range critical water infrastructure. As a result, these water providers have pledged over $500,000 to support this project.

E. Project Relation to Local Actions

Clearly describe how the project objectives align with the specific goals and objectives of an approved CWPP (or similar plan). Describe any local measures that reduce wildfire risk to people, property and infrastructure that the communities have adopted or plan to adopt (e.g., wildfire mitigation overlay zoning, participation in Firewise USA® program, hazard mitigation planning, forest management planning/implementation, existing slash/mulch collection or chipping programs, adoption of, or plans to adopt, county/local building codes for wildfire mitigation, demonstrated ongoing citizen outreach and education about wildfire risk, existing CWPPs/similar plans, etc.).

All information for the project must fit into the allotted 1,000-character space. Characters include letters, numbers, spaces and punctuation.

The Castle View project is located in Denver Water and Aurora Water Zones of Concern as well as a Rocky Mountain Restoration Initiative focus area, and they are directly adjacent to previous and planned Jefferson Conservation District, USFS, and CSFS treatments totaling approximately 3,000 acres which in turn connect to the High-Meadow Fire scar. This is the largest project from the CSFS Golden Field Office and will be the largest non-federal project that has been completed in the area. The CSFS Forest Action Plan also identifies this area as a high priority for treatment due to the risk of catastrophic wildfire to life, property, critical infrastructure, and water resources.

Treatments on the Windy Peak Outdoor Lab will help protect their historic structures, reduce hazardous snags along trails, and provide a unique opportunity to teach students about active forest management and forest dynamics as well.

F. Matching Contributions

This section is for matching share only. DO NOT show grant-requested funds in this table.

Contributors: Please specify the name of each match contributor and the dollar amount of each contribution.

Cash Match: Cash match is defined as direct funds made available to the project applicant (or their fiscal agent) for use in achieving work through the proposed project. This could include cash on hand, commitments from lending institutions or contributions from landowners with a signed letter indicating their commitment.

In-kind Match: In-kind match includes donated supplies, equipment, staff time or volunteer time/sweat equity directly related to the project. Donated time will be accounted for using current volunteer labor rates ($31.51/hour for 2023).

Applicants are required to demonstrate an ability to match requested grant funds for a minimum of a 1:1, or dollar-for-dollar, grant to match ratio. For example, if the total project budget is $100,000, the minimum match would be $50,000 and the grant funding request would be $50,000 (50%).

Proposed projects located within areas of fewer economic resources (cross-hatching in SVI layer) are required to match the requested grant funds for a minimum of 3:1, grant to match ratio. For example, if the total project budget is $100,000, the grant-funding request would be $75,000 and the minimum match would be $25,000 (25%).

Providing match beyond the minimum 50% requirement is allowed and will result in additional scoring preference for projects that are located outside of fewer economic resource areas. Because of this preference, successful applicants that propose additional match in this application must provide the proposed match ratio in order to receive full grant reimbursement.

Contributors: (Please specify)	Landowner	Denver Water	Aurora Water				**TOTAL**
Cash Match: (Dollars)	$ 292,500.00	$ 387,500.00	$ 150,000.00				$ 830,000.0
In-kind Match: (Hourly rate can't exceed $31.51)	$ 0.00	$ 0.00	$ 0.00				$ 0.00
TOTAL:	$ 292,500	$ 387,500	$ 150,000	$ 0.00	$ 0.00	$ 0.00	$ 830,000.0

G. Total Project Budget

This section should reflect the entire budget for the proposed project. The grant share column should reflect the state grant funds being requested in this application. The match columns should carry over information from Section *E. Matching Contributions* of the application. Please ensure that budget numbers are calculated correctly.

Personnel/Labor: Includes expenses directed toward staff time or labor (valued at actual salary amount).

- Grant administration activities such as compiling paperwork for reimbursements and reports cannot be included as part of the grant share, but is considered a cash match.
- Sweat equity (such as homeowner or volunteer labor) cannot be included as part of the grant share or cash match, but is considered an in-kind match at the volunteer hourly rate of $31.51 per individual.

Supplies/Materials: Include expenses for supplies or rental equipment used to complete project activities. Proposals for capital equipment purchases must be submitted in a separate Capacity Building application.

Contractual Services: Include expenses that will be contracted out to a third-party.

Indirect Costs: Include a wide variety of items not specifically broken out in the budget known as facilities and administrative costs (utilities, phone, copying, accounts payable, payroll, purchasing agent's time, and routine administrative services). Indirect costs paid by the grant may not exceed 10% of the grant total. Additional indirect costs (beyond 10%) may be used as cash match but must be documented with an established rate.

Anticipated project revenue: List anticipated cost offsets or revenues generated from the utilization of forest products or woody biomass. Any revenue generated by the project must be factored into the grant request. For example, if the cost for treatment is $3,000 per acre but utilization will decrease the cost to $2,500 per acre; show the $500 per acre as revenue, request funding based on the $2,500 per acre.

Examples of items that are not reimbursable or eligible to use as match: Equipment (i.e., chainsaws, tools), equipment repairs/parts/maintenance (i.e., oil changes, tires, chains), food/beverages, fundraising/investment/selling/marketing costs, decoration, office supplies, postage, telephone charges, computers/technological devises, and costs that don't directly relate to accomplishing proposed work.

Please be sure the totals from section E match totals below – totals in green *and* the totals in red must match.

TOTAL PROJECT BUDGET All budget line items must be described in Section *G. Budget*	**Grant Share ($ Amount requested)**	**Match (Carry over from Section *F.*)**		**TOTAL**
		Dollars	**In-Kind**	
Personnel/Labor:	$ 0.00	$ 50,000.00	$ 0.00	$ 50,000.00
Supplies/Materials:	$ 0.00	$ 5,000.00	$ 0.00	$ 5,000.00
Contractual Services:	$ 775,000.00	$ 775,000.00	$ 0.00	$ 1,550,000.00
Indirect Costs:	$ 0.00	$ 0.00	$ 0.00	$ 0.00
TOTAL PROJECT BUDGET	$ 775,000.00	$ 830,000.00	$ 0.00	$ 1,605,000.00
		$ 830,000.00		

Anticipated Project Revenue (from wood or biomass utilization)	$ 0.00

To calculate match %, divide the Total Match (purple box) with the Total Project Budget (blue box). If match is less than 50% (25% if eligible) of the total project budget, the application will be **disqualified**.

H. Budget Narrative

Describe each budget line items listed in Sections *F. Matching Contributions* and *G. Total Project Budget*. Clearly explain how specific project costs were estimated. For example, estimated per-acre costs of contracted work should be supported by bids or known costs from previous or similar projects. Per-hour labor rates should also be explained. Describe the role of each entity involved in project implementation, the known terms of contracts associated with the project, and the nature of in-kind contributions. Clearly explain any anticipated project revenue or cost-savings, how revenue is factored into the grant request, intended use of any revenue generated and how it will further the

objectives of the program. For example, will the revenue allow more acres to be treated? Describe any opportunity to leverage grant funds with other funding sources. Be as specific as possible when explaining how the funds will be allocated. Attach bids or contract estimates from industry, if applicable.

All information for the project must fit into the allotted 2,000-character space. Characters include letters, numbers, spaces and punctuation.

Grant Share:
The project are consists of approximately ~700 treatment acres. Based on bids CSFS has received for other projects in the area, the estimated cost/acre is estimated at approx. $2,200/ac for a total contractual cost of approx. $1,550,000. 50% of the contractual will come from the FRWRM grant for a total of $775,000 FRWRM grant funds for contractual.

Match:
FRWRM funds will be matched with Aurora Water (about $150,000 or 9.7%), Denver Water funds (about $387,500 or 25%), and private landowner funds (about $237,500 or 15.3%) to pay for the contractual costs of the project.

If this project is partially funded, there is potential to increase the funding from other partners and apply for federal grants to make the budget whole. There will also be future projects on these properties, so additional funding will be needed eventually.

For a project of this size, there will be a conservative estimate of $50,000 of personnel time and $5,000 to hire the Colorado State Forest Service to lay out the project and administer the contract.

Contractors will be required to remove product meeting CSFS utilization standards, which may slightly offset the costs of the project. However, most of the trees being removed have little to no value and there are very few wood outlets in the area that will pay enough to compensate for the fuel and labor of moving the wood products to have a significant impact on costs.

I. Project Area Description and Current Conditions

Describe the project area and current conditions including: geographical description, forest type, land ownership breakdown and acres, and the communities in which projects will take place including population, number of homes and structures, utilities and other values at risk. If project relates to a utility, describe utility service area, population served, and infrastructure and/or water supplies protected. **Participating landowners or organizations must be confirmed prior to applying**. Project locations should be focused on specific areas and not too broad in scope (county-wide descriptions/maps are too broad). The current condition description should describe the general current forest conditions (e.g., species composition, tree density, health, etc.). Provide details and explain how conditions were evaluated. Address how the project reduces hazardous fuels and/or improves forest conditions and to what extent.

All information for the project must fit into the allotted 2,000-character space. Characters include letters, numbers, spaces and punctuation.

There are 5 private landowners and 1 school district property currently involved in the project with a total 3,119 acres of ownership. This area southeast of Bailey (pop. 8,042) is a combination of USFS and private lands. The project area is directly adjacent to the Lost Creek Wilderness (which cannot receive treatment) and 75% of the perimeter is adjacent to the Pike-San Isabel National Forest. Three of the private landowners are current participants in the Forest Ag programs with active Forest Stewardship plans and 254 acres of past treatments.

Overall, all untreated forested stands are too densely stocked which is represented by their high basal areas and closed canopies. Interconnected crowns and excessive ladder fuels significantly increase the risk of crown fire throughout the project area. These stands need to be thinned to reduce fuel loading and improve forest health and wildlife habitat. The lodgepole pine present will be targeted for removal along with the majority of dead trees. Aspen and ponderosa pine will be promoted where present.

This project will connect to past and planned treatments and to large meadows with access roads creating a prominent suppression opportunity along USFS POD boundaries for a wildfire coming out of the unmanaged wilderness area. Through cross-boundary collaboration with the USFS, we will connect treatments all the way from the Lost Creek Wilderness to the High Meadow Fire that will make a significant landscape-scale impact.

J. Project Prescription and Scientific Foundation:

Describe the prescription and scientific foundation for the project and the specific practice standards that will be applied to achieve the desired outcomes of the project. Descriptions should be detailed and measurable and may include: the distance fuels mitigation work will be conducted from homes and structures, target basal area for forest thinning, target fuel loading, target percentage for the reduction of continuous tree and shrub canopy cover, etc. Describe how invasive species will be managed during project implementation as well as how wildlife impacts will be considered. Be sure to include a plan for slash management, if applicable.

Prescriptions should specifically address how projects will comply with Colorado Forestry Best Management Practices (BMPs). The scientific foundation should be substantiated by a reliable and professional resource with proper interpretation and recognized as appropriate to the local conditions found on the project site. Resources include publications such as CSFS guidelines and/or research articles from relevant studies appropriate to Colorado (e.g., research on Front Range forests by the Colorado Forest Restoration Institute and/or the Front Range Fuels Treatment Partnership), management plans, and the expertise of CSFS foresters, consultants or other professionals. CSFS guidelines include Forestry BMPs, thinning standards, and guidelines on defensible space, fuels mastication, shaded fuelbreak development, etc. Contact your local CSFS Field Office for assistance generating the project prescription.

Successful applicants may be required to submit a more detailed description prior to a grant award from the CSFS.

All information for the project must fit into the allotted 2,500-character space. Characters include letters, numbers, spaces and punctuation.

Forest Stewardship Plans (FSP) were developed for three of the private landowners by the CSFS Golden Field Office who will be administering the project and developing prescriptions for the other treatment areas as well. The FSPs include a forest inventory that was conducted across the project area to assess forest conditions, develop management recommendations, and guide forest management across the project area. Four broad forest types were identified: dry-mixed conifer, ponderosa pine, lodgepole pine, and spruce-fir. Those forest types were further divided into seven different operable stands that vary greatly in terms of species composition, structure, forest health, basal area, and understory.

Lodgepole pine is in especially poor condition and will be targeted for removal. Most of the tree regeneration present is Douglas-fir indicating that more desirable species like ponderosa pine are not regenerating in the shade of this overstocked forest. Furthermore, Douglas-fir has filled in much of the forest connecting crowns and creating vertical continuity of fuel and will be heavily thinned to create openings and break up the vertical and horizontal fuel continuity. Opening the canopy and removing a significant proportion of trees in the midstory and understory will provide an opportunity for shade intolerant species like aspen and ponderosa pine to regenerate. Increased sunlight on the forest floor will also increase growth of grasses and forbs which enhances wildlife habitat.

The principles outlined in GTR 373 will be followed to create a groupy-clumpy spatial distribution where appropriate in dry-mixed conifer stands. Theoretically, the residual stands should be able to support broadcast burning or a wildfire event with limited mortality. Over 440 acres were successfully broadcast burned in the nearby Payne Gulch proving the viability of prescribed fire in this area. While the majority of snags will be removed to reduce fuel loading, viable wildlife trees will be identified and protected.

Post-treatment basal area goals will range from 0 in dense lodgepole stands to 80 in riparian areas.

CSFS Home Ignition Zone guidelines will also be followed to protect the residents' structures, ingress, and egress from wildfire. This will be the primary goal for the Windy Peak Outdoor Lab campus to help protect student and staff cabins from fire. Where present, streamside management zones will be protected in accordance to Colorado Best Management Practices

K. Strategic Value of Project

Explain the strategic nature of the project. Identify if the proposed project will take place adjacent to or in close proximity to other planned or previously treated forest areas on state, municipal, private or federal lands. Explain whether the project will be implemented across land-ownership boundaries and if it is part of a larger landscape-scale treatment effort. Is the project within a priority area identified in a completed CWPP or FEMA Hazard Mitigation Plan? Describe the benefits the project will have to the respective community or residents. Explain how the proposed project will serve as a catalyst for future forest management projects.

All information for the project must fit into the allotted 1,500-character space. Characters include letters, numbers, spaces and punctuation.

The treatment areas will be implemented across 5 private landowner boundaries and the Jefferson County School District learning center, Windy Peak Outdoor Lab. This will connect to planned and previous treatments on adjacent federal lands in the Pike National Forest that span over 2,000 acres to make an impact on a landscape scale. USFS treatments such as the Jerome-Miller, Holmes, and Rolling Creek Project are examples of adjacent projects that will be joined together from this project. It will also connect the previous Forest Ag treatments by the 3 private landowners who are included in this project. These projects all either border or are close in proximity to the Lost Creek Wilderness, an area that is susceptible to devastating wildfire. This project area has been identified as a priority area for treatment due to risk to life, property, infrastructure, and water resources from agencies such as RMRI, Denver and Aurora Water Zones of Concern, USFS priority firesheds, Upper South Platte Partnership, and CSFS Forest Action Plan. This project will help connect fire suppression efforts made on federal and private lands to create a landscape level change. This will significantly reduce the risk of a devastating wildfire from occurring, and create opportunities for continued mitigation such as prescribed fire and thinning beyond the current project scopes. There has been interest in neighboring landowners who want to be involved in future grant applications to treat their land.

L. Forest Product Utilization

Describe plans for utilizing forest products/woody material from planned project sites or incorporating utilization into planning and project development efforts. Name the specific product(s) if applicable. Visit the Colorado Wood Utilization and Marketing website for further information on wood utilization.

Applicants are **required** to contact CoWood representative Tim Reader at (970) 247-5250 or tim.reader@colostate.edu for information on incorporating wood utilization into projects. List the names and dates of communications with any businesses that have been contacted regarding wood utilization. If any partnerships with industry are planned, provide those details also. Attach current bids or contract estimates from industry (if applicable).

All information for the project must fit into the allotted 1,500-character space. Characters include letters, numbers, spaces and punctuation.

Unfortunately, most of the trees being removed from these treatments are small diameter trees with little value including saplings under 4 inches DBH and decadent lodgepole pine with average diameters under 5 inches and less than 40 feet tall. As is the case with forest restoration treatments, the trees best suited for creating a timber product are most often selected for retention. Moreover, there are few mills in this area that are able to utilize this wood. As a result, creating a profit off this project is impossible.

That being said, the Colorado State Forest Service Golden Field Office's contracts require the contractor to utilize saw logs, fire wood, and biomass. We contacted Tim Reader on October 10th to notify him that the contractors hired to implement CSFS precriptions on the project will be required to utilize wood products produced by these treatments. We also reached out to Mike West with the Park County Sort Yard on October 12th to learn more of what types of forest products are in demand as well as how they will be utilized. Additionally, there is a timber mill located on one of the private properties that are a part of this project. It has not been actively used to this scale in several years, but they are also being contacted about their current opportunity with all the activity in the area on private and federal land.

M. Partners and Supporters

Describe coordination that will occur with participating groups/organizations and include partner contributions to the project. Specify conversations with county officials, including names, dates and locations, and describe how an accredited Colorado Youth Conservation or Veteran Corps organization, if any, will be included in the project. Include letters of support from relevant organizations as attachments along with formal commitments from financial institutions, landowners and/or industry.

All information for the project must fit into the allotted 1,000-character space. Characters include letters, numbers, spaces and punctuation.

The CSFS Golden Field Office and the 5 private landowners involved in the project will be collaborating with the Jefferson County School District's Windy Peak Outdoor Lab during the duration of the project. Elk Creek and North Fork Fire will assist in home ignition zone assessments and possibly treatments through their fuels crew for the campus at the Outdoor Lab. Denver Water and Aurora Water have collectively pledged over $500,000 of funding in support. The USFS has past and planned treatments across the fence from these treatment areas, and local CSFS staff are working with the USFS in planning additional treatments on National Forest land.

N. Timeline

Provide a timeline for the project including project beginning and end dates as well as project milestones with specific targets for completion. **All projects funded in this cycle must be completed by April 1, 2028.**

All information for the project must fit into the allotted 1,000-character space. Characters include letters, numbers, spaces and punctuation.

With a landscape-scale project this large, it will take several years and multiple projects to complete. For example, the second phase will be laid out while the first phase is being cut so there are multiple, consecutive phases over the grant period.

Year 1 (2024)
- Finalize funding
- Layout and contract development for phase 1
- By the end of the year, the goal is to have part of the project area under contract.

Year 2 (2025)
- Layout and contracting for phase 2
- 200 acres complete with reimbursement paperwork completed

Year 3 (2026)
- Post-treatment monitoring and weed-control for phase 1
- Layout and contracting for phase 3.
- 250 more acres complete with reimbursement paperwork completed

Year 4 (2027)
- Post-treatment monitoring and weed-control for phase 2
- 250 acres complete
- Project closeout and reimbursement paperwork completed

O. Maintenance/Sustainability

Outline long-term plans to monitor and maintain the improved landscape conditions achieved through implementation of the proposed project. Monitoring and maintenance activities that do not use grant dollars are expected to occur after the project period to sustain the benefits of the treatments. Identify who will plan and provide the project monitoring and maintenance services, how the work will be funded, what monitoring and maintenance will be needed to sustain the long-term benefits and at what frequency monitoring and maintenance will be necessary.

All information for the project must fit into the allotted 1,500-character space. Characters include letters, numbers, spaces and punctuation.

As part of the process of developing the project and renewing the forest management plan for the 3 landowners in the Forest Ag program, the CSFS Golden FO staff have spent time educating landowners involved about potential negative impacts of managing their forest and the need for ongoing maintenance on issues such as noxious weeds, slash, skid trails, blowdown, and regrowth. CSFS foresters will ensure skid trails and landings are rehabbed properly to reduce erosion. The primary immediate maintenance concern will be managing the noxious weeds that grow in the disturbed soil from heavy machinery. These weeds will be treated aggressively early on to control their population. There are 3 landowners that are renewing their Forest Ag Forest Management Plan which requires them to monitor and treat invasive weeds annually for the duration of the 10 year plan. There will likely be blowdown in areas of the treatment as a result of creating openings in the forest. Removing these trees will be at the discretion of the landowner as they will not represent a large fuel load and will largely be an issue of aesthetics. Trees that regenerate are recommended to be managed to maintain the healthy forest by means of thinning for spacing and species composition.

Note: Additional support materials beyond the allowable support letters, maps and contract bids will not be considered.

The following page provide guidance to applicants on criteria the Technical Advisory Panel will use to score and evaluate applications.

SCORING SHEET **Final Score: / 70**

Project Relation to Forest Action Plan *(Section D)* **Score: /5 pts**
Are project objectives clearly defined and do they align with specific FAP goals, and the overall FRWRM Program goals? Are the approaches to meet project objectives described, appropriate and scientifically supported?

Project Relation to Local Actions *(Section E)* **Score: /5 pts**
Does the project fit into the goals of a specific CWPP or other similar collaborative plan? Have the community(s) adopted local measures to reduce wildfire risk?

Budget *(Sections F, G & H)* **Score: /10 pts**
Do costs seem reasonable and/or justified for the proposed work? Are expenditures clear, and have utilization revenues been considered and explained? Does the budget provide effective leverage for other funds or in-kind contributions? Are quotes or cost justification for project work included? Are budget calculations accurate?

Project Area Description/Current Conditions *(Sections I)* **Score: /10 pts**
How well is the project area defined? Are current conditions detailed and clear? All allowable maps included will be considered (2020 FAP Composite Priority map, other FAP theme maps, CWPP maps, etc.). Do the maps align, and in what priority value is the project located? Is the project likely to be effective in reducing risk to identified values?

Project Prescription and Scientific Foundation *(Section J)* **Score: /10 pts**
How appropriate are the standards and prescriptions to achieve the project and grant program's objectives within the current forest condition? Do the scientific standards reflect best available information? Are applicable Colorado Forestry BMPs addressed? Have applicants consulted with experts? Have CSFS guidelines been integrated? Are the prescription standards detailed and measurable?

Strategic Value of Project *(Section K)* **Score: /5 pts**
Does the project tier to a county plan or relevant CWPP? Is there an emphasis on a regional approach? Is it adjacent or in close proximity to other planned or previously treated areas? Will the project achieve results at a meaningful scale?

Forest Product Utilization *(Section L)* **Score: /5 pts**
Has the applicant made an effort to include wood utilization and do utilization plans appear to maximize the possibilities? Has the applicant corresponded with any wood products businesses? Are details provided?

Partners and Supporters *(Section M)* **Score: /5 pts**
Does the project maximize use of partners and supporters? Are partner contributions clearly articulated? Has partner communication been discussed? Letters of support will be reviewed, including required letter from county official.

Timeline *(Section N)* **Score: /5 pts**
Is the timeline organized with clearly defined beginning and end dates, project milestones (outreach, mitigation, hiring, etc) and specific targets completed at specific times? Does the proposed timeline seem achievable?

Maintenance/Sustainability *(Section O)* **Score: /5 pts**
Is there an appropriate plan to maintain the project after completion? Does the maintenance plan include details of who will accomplish maintenance tasks, how the work will be funded and how often activities will occur?

Additional Consideration/Preference **Score: /5 pts**
Additional points will be given to applications that demonstrate:

- Additional leverage of resources and collaboration
- Adoption of local measures to reduce wildfire risk
- Partnership with youth and/or Veterans Groups
- Protection of water supplies

Colorado Risk Reduction Planner

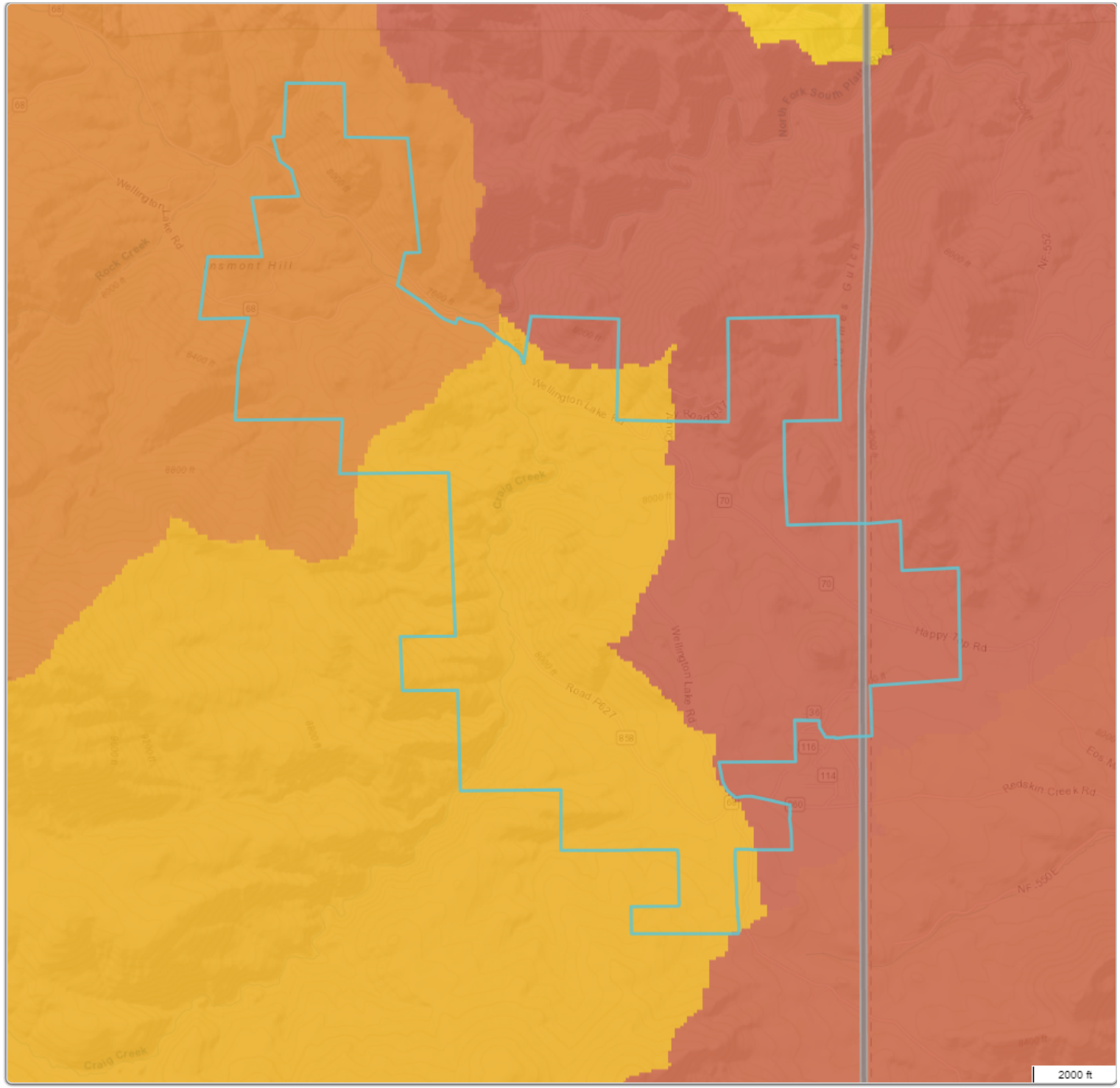
https://co-pro.coloradoforestatlas.org

Forest Action Plan Composite

Represents priority areas where goals from the forest conditions, living with wildfire, and watershed protection themes can be achieved on the same management footprint by a project or activity.

Created on:

10/18/2023, 4:40 PM



Disclaimer

The user assumes the entire risk related to their use of the Colorado Wildfire Risk Public Viewer and either the published or derived products from these data.

The Colorado State Forest Service is providing these data "as is" and disclaims any and all warranties, whether expressed or implied, including (without limitation) any implied warranties of merchantability or fitness for a particular purpose.

In no event will Colorado State Forest Service be liable to you or to any third party for any direct, indirect, incidental, consequential, special or exemplary damages or lost profit resulting from any use or misuse of these data.

Legend

https://co-pro.coloradoforestatlas.org

Counties

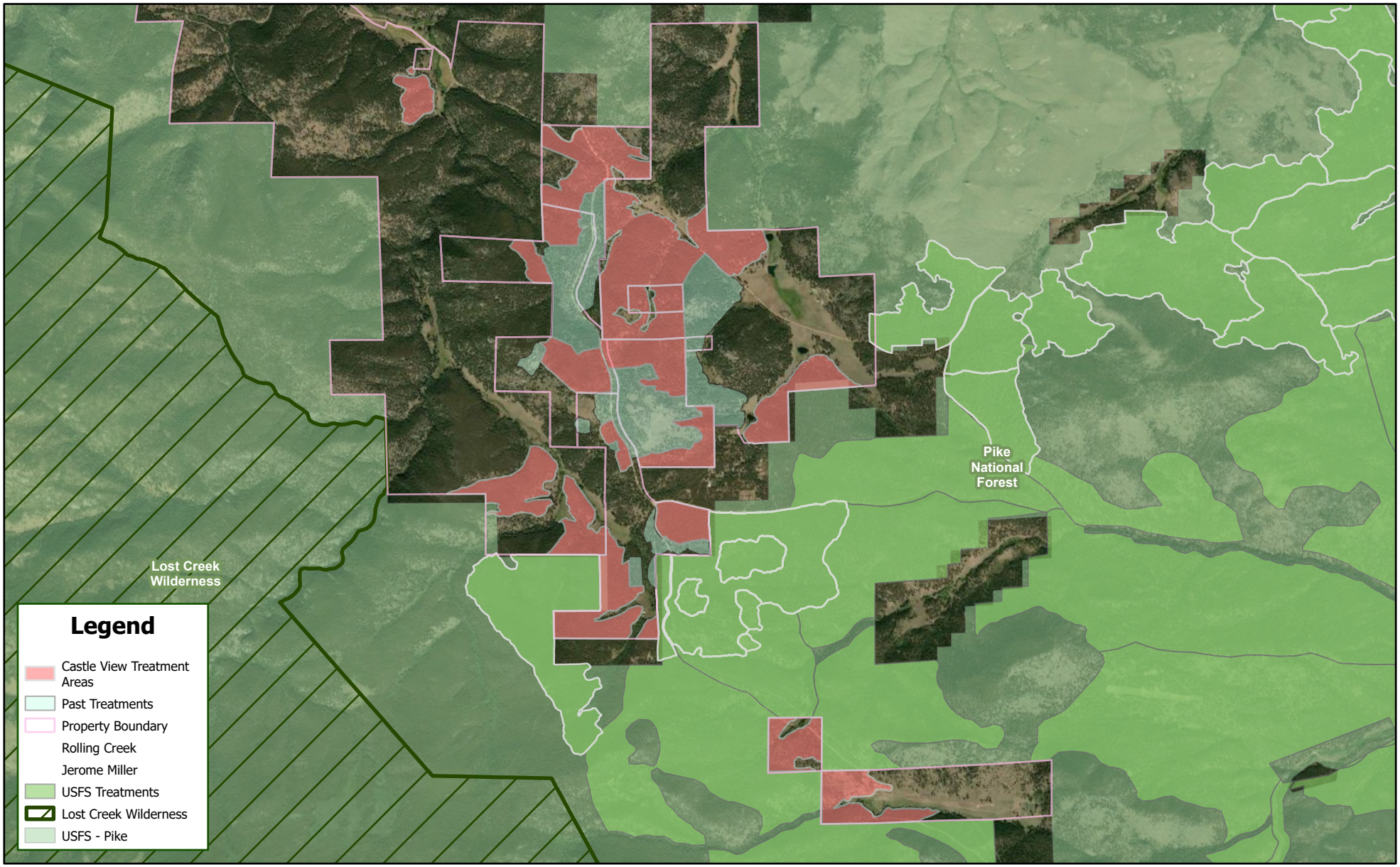
Social Vulnerability Index

Qualifying

Forest Action Plan Composite



Castle View



N

0 2,500 5,000 7,500 10,000 Feet

1:40,000
Datum: North American 1983
Projection: Transverse Mercator
Date Exported: 10/19/2023 8:40 AM

COLORADO STATE FOREST SERVICE
COLORADO STATE UNIVERSITY

JEFFERSON COUNTY COLORADO

Lesley Dahlkemper, District No. 3

October 10, 2023

Forest Restoration and Wildfire Risk Mitigation (FRWRM) Grant – Advisory Committee
Colorado State Forest Service, Forest Planning & Implementation Division
5060 Campus Deliver
Fort Collins, CO 80523-5060

RE: Castle View Forest Restoration: Forest Restoration & Wildfire Risk Mitigation Grant Program

Dear FRWRM Grant Advisory Committee,

As part of Jefferson County's commitment to wildfire risk mitigation, I am in support of Castle View's application. The implementation of this project promotes forest resilience, watershed & community protection, wildlife management and recreation resources in a high priority area as determined in the 2020 Forest Action Plan.

Disturbances such as wildfire and insect & disease have had negative social and economic impacts to the Upper South Platte Watershed in the past – and are likely to do the same in the future. The 2020 wildfire season is an indicator of the potential for severity of and damage to the people and resources of Colorado. This community of 5 landowners and the Jefferson County Public school system is engaged in proactively managing the risks, threats and impacts of disturbance from and to the natural environment.

The funds from this grant will reduce the risk of catastrophic wildfire in a critical watershed and protect human life, property, and natural resources. This project will build off previous state and federal treatments and contribute to the goal of creating an effective fuel break across the landscape aimed at protecting communities, forests, and essential water resources. It will also be a great opportunity for cross-boundary collaboration with involvement from the Upper South Platte Partnership, Rocky Mountain Restoration Initiative, and the United States Forest Service on the Pike National Forest and serve as a catalyst for future mitigation projects in the area.

I highly encourage your consideration for funding. Thank you for your time and attention.

Sincerely,

Lesley Dahlkemper
Jefferson County Commissioner

LD/dc

October 9, 2023

Forest Restoration and Wildfire Risk Mitigation (FRWRM) Grant – Advisory Committee
Colorado State Forest Service, Forest Planning & Implementation Division
5060 Campus Deliver
Fort Collins, CO 80523-5060

RE: Castle View Forest Restoration
Forest Restoration and Wildfire Risk Mitigation (FRWRM) grant program

Dear FRWRM Grant Advisory Committee,

This letter shall serve as a confirmation of support and Jefferson County Sheriff Erika Robert's commitment in providing the matching funds for Mr. Driscoll's application, **Castle View Forest Restoration**, for the 2023-2024 FRWRM Grant Program. The implementation of this project promotes forest resilience, watershed & community protection, wildlife management and recreation resources in a high priority area as determined in the 2020 Forest Action Plan.

Disturbances such as wildfire and insect & disease have had negative social and economic impacts to the Upper South Platte Watershed in the past – and are likely to do the same in the future. The 2020 wildfire season is an indicator of the potential for severity of and damage to the people and resources of Colorado. This community of 5 landowners and the Jefferson County Public school system is engaged in proactively managing the risks, threats and impacts of disturbance from and to the natural environment.

The funds from this grant will reduce the risk of catastrophic wildfire in a critical watershed and protect human life, property, natural resources. This project will build off previous state and federal treatments, and contribute to the goal of creating an effective fuelbreak across the landscape aimed at protecting communities, forests, and essential water resources. It will also be a great opportunity for cross-boundary collaboration with involvement from the Upper South Platte Partnership, Rocky Mountain Restoration Initiative, and the United States Forest Service on the Pike National Forest and serve as a catalyst for future mitigation projects in the area.

The Jefferson County Sheriff's office supports this application and highly encourages your consideration for funding. Thank you for your time and attention.

Respectfully,
REGGI MARINELLI
Sheriff

Mark Gutke
Wildland Program Manager

856 Castello Ave
Fairplay, CO. 80440
P.O. Box 1373
Fairplay, CO 80440
(719) 836-4201 (Fairplay)
(719) 836-3273 (Fax)
Website: www.parkco.us

County of Park
BOARD OF COUNTY COMMISSIONERS

October 10, 2023

Forest Restoration and Wildfire Risk Mitigation (FRWRM) Grant – Advisory Committee
Colorado State Forest Service, Forest Planning & Implementation Division
5060 Campus Deliver
Fort Collins, CO 80523-5060

RE: Castle View Forest Restoration
Forest Restoration and Wildfire Risk Mitigation (FRWRM) grant program

Dear FRWRM Grant Advisory Committee,

Please accept this letter of support from Park County of Mr. Driscoll's application, **Castle View Forest Restoration**, for the 2023-2024 FRWRM Grant Program. The implementation of this project promotes forest resilience, watershed & community protection, wildlife management and recreation resources in a high priority area as determined in the 2020 Forest Action Plan.

Disturbances such as wildfire and insect & disease have had negative social and economic impacts to the Upper South Platte Watershed in the past – and are likely to do the same in the future. The 2020 wildfire season is an indicator of the potential for severity of and damage to the people and resources of Colorado. This community of 5 landowners and the Jefferson County Public school system is engaged in proactively managing the risks, threats and impacts of disturbance from and to the natural environment.

The funds from this grant will reduce the risk of catastrophic wildfire in a critical watershed and protect human life, property, natural resources. This project will build off previous state and federal treatments, and contribute to the goal of creating an effective fuel break across the landscape aimed at protecting communities, forests, and essential water resources. It will also be a great opportunity for cross-boundary collaboration with involvement from the Upper South Platte Partnership, Rocky Mountain Restoration Initiative, and the United States Forest Service on the Pike National Forest and serve as a catalyst for future mitigation projects in the area.

The Park County Board of County Commissioners supports this application and highly encourages your consideration for funding. Thank you for your time and attention.

Sincerely,

Amy Mitchell
Chair
Park County Board of County Commissioners
856 Castello Avenue
Fairplay, CO 80440

TAMMY STORY
House District 25

STATE CAPITOL BUILDING
200 E. COLFAX AVENUE
DENVER, COLORADO 80203

Forest Restoration and Wildfire Risk Mitigation (FRWRM) Grant – Advisory Committee
Colorado State Forest Service, Forest Planning & Implementation Division
5060 Campus Deliver
Fort Collins, CO 80523-5060

RE: Castle View Forest Restoration
Forest Restoration and Wildfire Risk Mitigation (FRWRM) grant program

Dear FRWRM Grant Advisory Committee,

My name is Tammy Story, I am the State Representative of Colorado House District 25. I represent the mountains of Jeffco south of I-70, one of the most at-risk areas in our state for devastating wildfires. I am writing in support of providing the matching funds for Mr. Driscoll's application, **Castle View Forest Restoration**, for the 2023-2024 FRWRM Grant Program. The implementation of this project promotes forest resilience, watershed & community protection, wildlife management and recreation resources in a high priority area as determined in the 2020 Forest Action Plan.

Disturbances such as wildfire and insect & disease have had negative social and economic impacts to the Upper South Platte Watershed in the past – and are likely to do the same in the future. The 2020 wildfire season is an indicator of the potential for severity of and damage to the people and resources of Colorado. This community of 5 landowners and the Jefferson County Public school system is engaged in proactively managing the risks, threats and impacts of disturbance from and to the natural environment.

The funds from this grant will reduce the risk of catastrophic wildfire in a critical watershed and protect human life, property, and natural resources. This project will build off previous state and federal treatments, and contribute to the goal of creating an effective fuelbreak across the landscape aimed at protecting communities, forests, and essential water resources. It will also be a great opportunity for cross-boundary collaboration with involvement from the Upper South Platte Partnership, Rocky Mountain Restoration Initiative, and the United States Forest Service on the Pike National Forest and serve as a catalyst for future mitigation projects in the area.

I fully support this application and highly encourage your consideration for funding. Thank you for your time and attention.

Sincerely,

Representative Tammy Story

State Representative
JULIE McCLUSKIE
Colorado State Capitol
200 East Colfax Avenue, Room 307
Denver, Colorado 80203
Office: 303-866-2952
Cell: 970-977-0021
Email: julie.mccluskie.house@coleg.gov

SPEAKER OF THE HOUSE
Vice-Chair:
Executive Committee of the
Legislative Council
Legislative Council Committee

COLORADO
HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES
State Capitol
Denver
80203

October 10, 2023

Forest Restoration and Wildfire Risk Mitigation (FRWRM) Grant – Advisory Committee
Colorado State Forest Service, Forest Planning & Implementation Division
5060 Campus Deliver
Fort Collins, CO 80523-5060

RE: Castle View Forest Restoration
Forest Restoration and Wildfire Risk Mitigation (FRWRM) grant program

Dear FRWRM Grant Advisory Committee,

I am writing to share my support for the commitment to provide the matching funds for Mr. Driscoll's application, **Castle View Forest Restoration**, for the 2023-2024 FRWRM Grant Program. The implementation of this project promotes forest resilience, watershed & community protection, wildlife management, and recreation resources in a high-priority area as determined in the 2020 Forest Action Plan.

Disturbances such as wildfire and insect & disease have had negative social and economic impacts on the Upper South Platte Watershed in the past – and are likely to do the same in the future. The 2020 wildfire season is an indicator of the potential for severity of and damage to the people and resources of Colorado. This community of 5 landowners and the Jefferson County Public School system is engaged in proactively managing the risks, threats and impacts of disturbance from and to the natural environment.

The funds from this grant will reduce the risk of catastrophic wildfire in a critical watershed and protect human life, property, and natural resources. This project will build off previous state and federal treatments and contribute to creating an effective fuelbreak across the landscape to protect communities, forests, and essential water resources. It will also be an excellent opportunity for cross-boundary collaboration with involvement from the Upper South Platte Partnership, Rocky Mountain Restoration Initiative, and the United States Forest Service on the Pike National Forest and serve as a catalyst for future mitigation projects in the area.

I support this application and highly encourage your consideration for funding. Thank you for your time and attention.

Sincerely,



Julie McCluskie
Speaker of the CO House of Representatives

DENVER WATER

1600 W. 12th Ave.
Denver, CO 80204-3412
303-628-6000
denverwater.org

October 13, 2023

Forest Restoration and Wildfire Risk Mitigation (FRWRM) Grant – Advisory Committee
Colorado State Forest Service, Forest Planning & Implementation Division
5060 Campus Deliver
Fort Collins, CO 80523-5060

RE: Castle View Forest Restoration
Forest Restoration and Wildfire Risk Mitigation (FRWRM) grant program

Dear FRWRM Grant Advisory Committee,

This letter shall serve as a confirmation of support and Denver Water's commitment in providing the matching funds for Mr. Driscoll's application, **Castle View Forest Restoration**, for the 2023-2024 FRWRM Grant Program. As the water provider to 1.5 million people in the Denver metropolitan area, Denver Water directly depends on healthy forests and watersheds. In overgrown forests in the Upper South Platte watershed, high-intensity wildfires have negatively impacted water resources. The implementation of this project promotes forest resilience, watershed and community protection, wildlife management and recreation resources in a high priority area as determined in the 2020 Forest Action Plan.

Disturbances such as wildfire and insect and disease have had negative social and economic impacts to the Upper South Platte Watershed in the past – and are likely to do the same in the future. The 2020 wildfire season is an indicator of the potential for severity of and damage to the people and resources of Colorado. This community of 5 landowners and the Jefferson County Public School system is engaged in proactively managing the risks, threats and impacts of disturbance from and to the natural environment.

The funds from this grant will reduce the risk of catastrophic wildfire in a critical watershed and protect human life, property, natural resources. This project will build off previous state and federal treatments and contribute to the goal of creating an effective fuelbreak across the landscape aimed at protecting communities, forests, and essential water resources. It will also be a great opportunity for cross-boundary collaboration with involvement from the Upper South Platte Partnership, Rocky Mountain Restoration Initiative, and the United States Forest Service on the Pike National Forest and serve as a catalyst for future mitigation projects in the area.

Denver Water is proud to support this application and highly encourages your consideration for funding. Thank you for your time and attention.

Sincerely,

Madelene McDonald

Madelene McDonald
Denver Water, Watershed Scientist

Thornton Infrastructure Maintenance Center
12450 Washington Street
Thornton, CO 80241
www.ThorntonCO.gov

Infrastructure Department
Water Resources Division
PH 720-977-6600

October 18, 2023

Forest Restoration and Wildfire Risk Mitigation (FRWRM) Grant – Advisory Committee
Colorado State Forest Service, Forest Planning & Implementation Division
5060 Campus Deliver
Fort Collins, CO 80523-5060

RE: Castle View Forest Restoration
Forest Restoration and Wildfire Risk Mitigation (FRWRM) grant program

Dear FRWRM Grant Advisory Committee,

This letter shall serve as a confirmation of support for Mr. Driscoll's application, Castle View Forest Restoration, for the 2023-2024 FRWRM Grant Program. The implementation of this project promotes forest resilience, watershed & community protection, wildlife management and recreation resources in a high priority area as determined in the 2020 Forest Action Plan.

Disturbances such as wildfire and insect & disease have had negative social and economic impacts to the Upper South Platte Watershed in the past – and are likely to do the same in the future. The 2020 wildfire season is an indicator of the potential for severity of and damage to the people and resources of Colorado. The community of 5 landowners and the Jefferson County Public school system is engaged in proactively managing the risks, threats and impacts of disturbance from and to the natural environment.

The funds from this grant will reduce the risk of catastrophic wildfire in a critical watershed and protect human life, property, and natural resources. This project will build off previous state and federal treatments and contribute to the goal of creating an effective fuelbreak across the landscape aimed at protecting communities, forests, and essential water resources. It will also be a great opportunity for cross-boundary collaboration with involvement from the Upper South Platte Partnership, Rocky Mountain Restoration Initiative, and the United States Forest Service on the Pike National Forest and serve as a catalyst for future mitigation projects in the area.

The City of Thornton supports this application and encourages your consideration for funding. Thank you for your time and attention.

Sincerely,



Emily Hunt
Deputy Infrastructure Director
City of Thornton

USDA United States Department of Agriculture
Forest Service
Pike and San Isabel National Forests
Cimarron and Comanche National Grasslands
South Platte Ranger District
30403 Kings Valley Dr., Suite 2-115
Conifer, CO, 80433
303-275-5610
Fax: 303-275-5642

File Code:
Date: October 16, 2023

Forest Restoration and Wildfire Risk Mitigation (FRWRM) Grant – Advisory Committee
Colorado State Forest Service, Forest Planning & Implementation Division
5060 Campus Deliver
Fort Collins, CO 80523-5060

RE: Castle View Forest Restoration
Forest Restoration and Wildfire Risk Mitigation (FRWRM) grant program

Dear FRWRM Grant Advisory Committee,

This letter shall serve as a confirmation of support and the United States Forest Service's commitment in providing the matching funds for the Colorado State Land Board's application, **Castle View Forest Restoration**, for the 2023-2024 FRWRM Grant Program. The implementation of this project promotes forest resilience, watershed & community protection, wildlife management and recreation resources in a high priority area as determined in the 2020 Forest Action Plan.

Disturbances such as wildfire and insect & disease have had negative social and economic impacts to the Upper South Platte Watershed in the past – and are likely to do the same in the future. The 2020 wildfire season is an indicator of the potential for severity of and damage to the people and resources of Colorado. This community of 5 landowners and the Jefferson County Public school system is engaged in proactively managing the risks, threats and impacts of disturbance from and to the natural environment.

The funds from this grant will reduce the risk of catastrophic wildfire in a critical watershed and protect human life, property, natural resources. This project will build off previous state and federal treatments, and contribute to the goal of creating an effective fuelbreak across the landscape aimed at protecting communities, forests, and essential water resources. It will also be a great opportunity for cross-boundary collaboration with involvement from the Upper South Platte Partnership, Rocky Mountain Restoration Initiative, and the United States Forest Service on the Pike National Forest and serve as a catalyst for future mitigation projects in the area.

The United States Forest Service supports this application and highly encourages your consideration for funding. Thank you for your time and attention.

Sincerely,

X

BRIAN BANKS
South Platte District Ranger
USDA Forest Service-PSICC

cc:

Platte Canyon Fire Protection District

P.O. Box 222, Bailey, CO 80421
303-838-5853

October 10, 2023

Forest Restoration and Wildfire Risk Mitigation (FRWRM) Grant – Advisory Committee
Colorado State Forest Service, Forest Planning & Implementation Division
5060 Campus Deliver
Fort Collins, CO 80523-5060

RE: Castle View Forest Restoration
Forest Restoration and Wildfire Risk Mitigation (FRWRM) grant program

Dear FRWRM Grant Advisory Committee,

This letter shall serve as a confirmation of support and Platte Canyon Fire's commitment in providing the matching funds for Mr. Driscoll's application, **Castle View Forest Restoration**, for the 2023-2024 FRWRM Grant Program. The implementation of this project promotes forest resilience, watershed & community protection, wildlife management and recreation resources in a high priority area as determined in the 2020 Forest Action Plan.

Disturbances such as wildfire and insect & disease have had negative social and economic impacts to the Upper South Platte Watershed in the past -- and are likely to do the same in the future. The 2020 wildfire season is an indicator of the potential for severity of and damage to the people and resources of Colorado. This community of 5 landowners and the Jefferson County Public school system is engaged in proactively managing the risks, threats and impacts of disturbance from and to the natural environment.

The funds from this grant will reduce the risk of catastrophic wildfire in a critical watershed and protect human life, property, natural resources. This project will build off previous state and federal treatments, and contribute to the goal of creating an effective fuelbreak across the landscape aimed at protecting communities, forests, and essential water resources. It will also be a great opportunity for cross-boundary collaboration with involvement from the Upper South Platte Partnership, Rocky Mountain Restoration Initiative, and the United States Forest Service on the Pike National Forest and serve as a catalyst for future mitigation projects in the area.

Platte Canyon Fire supports this application and highly encourages your consideration for funding. Thank you for your time and attention.

Sincerely,

Jared Black
Deputy Chief
Platte Canyon Fire Protection District

North Fork Fire Protection District
P O Box 183
Buffalo Creek, CO 80425-0183
Phone: 303-838-2270
Fax: 303-838-0412

October 16, 2023

Forest Restoration and Wildfire Risk Mitigation (FRWRM) Grant – Advisory Committee
Colorado State Forest Service, Forest Planning & Implementation Division5060 Campus Deliver
Fort Collins, CO 80523-5060

RE: Castle View Forest Restoration
Forest Restoration and Wildfire Risk Mitigation (FRWRM) grant program

Dear FRWRM Grant Advisory Committee,

This letter shall serve North Fork Fire's support for Mr. Driscoll's application, Castle View Forest Restoration, for the 2023-2024 FRWRM Grant Program. The implementation of this project promotes forest resilience, watershed & community protection, wildlife management and recreation resources in a high priority area as determined in the 2020 Forest Action Plan.

Disturbances such as wildfire and insect & disease have had negative social and economic impacts to the Upper South Platte Watershed in the past – and are likely to do the same in the future. The 2020 wildfire season is an indicator of the potential for severity of and damage to the people and resources of Colorado. This community of 5 landowners and the Jefferson County Public school system is engaged in proactively managing the risks, threats and impacts of disturbance from and to the natural environment.

The funds from this grant will reduce the risk of catastrophic wildfire in a critical watershed and protect human life, property, natural resources. This project will build off previous state and federal treatments, and contribute to the goal of creating an effective fuelbreak across the landscape aimed at protecting communities, forests, and essential water resources. It will also be a great opportunity for cross-boundary collaboration with involvement from the Upper South Platte Partnership, Rocky Mountain Restoration Initiative, and the United States Forest Service on the Pike National Forest and serve as a catalyst for future mitigation projects in the area.

North Fork Fire supports this application and highly encourages your consideration for funding. Thank you for your time and attention.

Sincerely,

Curt D Rogers

Curt D. Rogers, Chief

Windy Peak Outdoor Lab School
Jefferson County Public Schools
Robb Gneiser, Principal
P.O. Box 435
Bailey, CO 80421
phone: 303-982-9494

05 October 2023

Forest Restoration and Wildfire Risk Mitigation (FRWRM) Grant – Advisory
Committee Colorado State Forest Service, Forest Planning & Implementation Division
5060 Campus Deliver
Fort Collins, CO 80523-5060

RE: Castle View Forest Restoration
Forest Restoration and Wildfire Risk Mitigation (FRWRM) grant program

Dear FRWRM Grant Advisory Committee,

This letter shall serve as a confirmation of support and Jefferson County School District's commitment to providing the matching funds for Mr. Driscoll's application, **Castle View Forest Restoration**, for the 2023-2024 FRWRM Grant Program. The implementation of this project promotes forest resilience, watershed & community protection, wildlife management, and recreation resources in a high-priority area as determined in the 2020 Forest Action Plan.

Disturbances such as wildfire and insect & disease have had negative social and economic impacts on the Upper South Platte Watershed in the past – and are likely to do the same in the future. The 2020 wildfire season is an indicator of the potential for severity of and damage to the people and resources of Colorado. This community of 5 landowners and the Jefferson County Public School system are proactively managing the risks, threats, and impacts of disturbance from and to the environment.

The funds from this grant will reduce the risk of catastrophic wildfire in a critical watershed and protect human life, property, and natural resources. This project will build off previous state and federal treatments, and contribute to the goal of creating an effective fuel break across the landscape aimed at protecting communities, forests, and essential water resources. It will also be a great opportunity for cross-boundary collaboration with involvement from the Upper South Platte Partnership, Rocky Mountain Restoration Initiative, and the United States Forest Service on the Pike National Forest and serve as a catalyst for future mitigation projects in the area.

The Jefferson County School District supports this application and highly encourages your consideration for funding. Thank you for your time and attention.

Sincerely,

Robert M. Gneiser
Principal, Windy Peak Outdoor Education Laboratory School, Jefferson County Public Schools